ECECS Engineering Internship Post 2026

Please note: This job description **must** be used when completing the **set exercise** (employability portfolio) assessment & the **group interview** assessment. This internship post is fictitious but representative of current opportunities.

Title:	Young Engineer Summer Research Internship 2026
Organisation:	Praxis Solutions (Ref: PS2026a)
Location:	Dunfermline, Scotland – with one international site visit
Duration:	8 weeks, summer 2026 (July/Aug)
Salary:	£27,000 pro rata

Who are we?

Praxis Solutions is an international NGO which develops and implements engineering solutions to specific problems faced by communities around the world. We focus in particular on parts of the world where factors such as poor infrastructure or a lack of local investment can make it challenging to implement positive change. We work with a pool of engineering talent from top universities, research institutions and private companies, alongside a wide range of local and national governments, charities and development funds, to:

- identify pressing issues affecting specific localities
- research and evaluate solutions, taking into account local conditions
- define and cost the optimum solution
- secure public and private funding
- manage and implement the solution in collaboration with local bodies

What's this internship about?

Praxis' interdisciplinary teams typically work on projects connected to the *NAE Grand Challenges for Engineering*, and our unique **Young Engineer Summer Research Internship** supports successful candidates to investigate **one** of the challenges in the context of a **specific locality**. For this year's programme, we ask you to focus on the challenge to **Restore and Improve Urban Infrastructure**. That means choosing a **location** (a city or town) with a specific **issue** related to urban infrastructure that you believe can be solved by engineers.

If you are accepted as one of our summer interns, you will work closely with a team to sharpen your research and critical thinking skills, investigate approaches to solving the issue you have identified, and produce a report which recommends the optimum solution. Your idea will then have the chance to become reality! Our project leaders will evaluate and select the best ideas

and take them to the costing stage – and if funding can be secured, you will be invited to take an active role in the project team!

What else can I get out of this internship?
While working on your own idea, you will be shadowing an active project team to experience exactly how our cutting-edge engineering solutions are crafted and implemented to meet the needs of a community somewhere in the world. You could be looking at a water treatment project in Nairobi, Kenya, a VR training programme for medical workers in rural Indonesia, or the construction of a solar energy community in Guatemala City. You'll work closely with our project managers and lead engineers and take part directly in some of the tasks involved, from helping prepare project updates for meetings to assisting with equipment tests and calculation checks – all invaluable experience to boost your CV, inform your ongoing studies, and expand your career options. And what's more – in addition to remote collaboration, we will throw in an expenses-paid site visit to where the project is located for you to see exactly how international cooperation works on the ground.

We are looking for people who:

- are undergraduate engineers from any relevant subdiscipline (civil, environmental, electrical, electronics, software) with a solid academic record in their subject
- have a passion for making a difference to the world
- understand the principles and practice of effective research – with a desire to take these critical skills to the next level
- can solve problems elegantly and efficiently using technical understanding, maths and IT skills
- can collaborate effectively, with the ability to work under supervision and with others from different technical backgrounds – any experience of teamwork and/or effective leadership, whether at work, study or play, is relevant to this position
- are effective English users, with the ability to communicate clearly about projects and outcomes with stakeholders who may be in a technical or non-technical role

Above all, we want candidates who have demonstrable **independent** skills in all the key areas above, and do not need to rely on machines to shine! Being able to work *with* AI is an advantage, but being dependent on it is a red flag for us. You will have the chance to show off your independent voice and vision from the beginning of the application process – we have seen enough AI-generated applications to last a lifetime, and we expect better from budding Praxis interns!

We don't just want students with ambition and strong academic records – we're looking for young changemakers who have the right educational foundations, a willingness to learn and the imagination to help communities around the world overcome challenges.

Equality, Diversity and Inclusion – in the workplace and beyond
We believe that equality, diversity and inclusion are fundamental to creating a positive, dynamic and thriving workplace culture. We encourage individuals from diverse backgrounds to apply and become part of our forward-thinking company. However, we don't stop there. All our diverse projects have one key common thread – they all help boost inclusion within the communities they take place in. That is why, in your application, you will need to explain how your project proposal helps address inequality or exclusion in the location you have chosen.

To apply, please submit the following by the deadline of Monday 13th April 2026

You must submit a **CV** of no more than **two** pages, and a cover letter of **220-260 words**.

In your **CV**, in addition to telling us about your education, experience and skills, you must include a **brief** outline of your project, comprising:

- a **working title**
- the **location** (city or town) you have chosen
- **an issue** related to urban infrastructure that your project hopes to address

Your **cover letter** must include:

- how you meet the requirements and what attracts you to this post
- your **motivation** for proposing your project
- how your project idea fits with our policy on **Equality, Diversity and Inclusion**

The cover letter should be addressed to:
Ms Yashmeen Halfcourt
Internships Director
Praxis Solutions
8 Kings Wynd
Dunfermline
UK
KY22 6TZ

If you are successful at this stage, we will invite you to take part in a group interview.